

overcome their own challenges and found their own truths while achieving FI quickly. I could take these lessons and look at common themes and patterns to develop principles that anyone could use to develop their own personalized path to achieve this rare yet very achievable outcome of financial independence.

A few months after this idea began rattling around in my head, I stumbled upon a new podcast, *Choose FI*. I listened to a few episodes. One of the hosts, Brad Barrett, was at a stage in life similar to my own. Co-host Jonathan Mendonsa was at a point where I had been a few years earlier. He had a palpable excitement to go down this road and a desire to grow and learn, but with some obvious blind spots that I was able to spot quickly due to my own past mistakes.

I found myself rooting for them to be bad and fail. I viewed them as competitors who beat me to the punch in doing exactly what I wanted to do with the podcast. However, as I listened to them, I couldn't help but to become a huge fan and see that these guys got it and were building something special.

It made no sense to try to reinvent the wheel and compete with them. Instead, I contacted them and asked if they would be interested in teaming up. I would use their interviews as the basis for